

Embedding (sovereign) AI:

Don't burn your fingers in the heat of the AI revolution

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Keep your options open



Don't marry



What's happening in the world?



AI is becoming geopolitical infrastructure

Over 2.5m users boycott ChatGPT after OpenAI-Pentagon deal



- <https://www.reuters.com/business/us-treasury-ending-all-use-anthropic-products-says-bessent-2026-03-02>
- <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cn48jj3y8ezo>
- <https://www.tbsnews.net/tech/over-25m-users-boycott-chatgpt-after-openai-pentagon-deal-1376856>



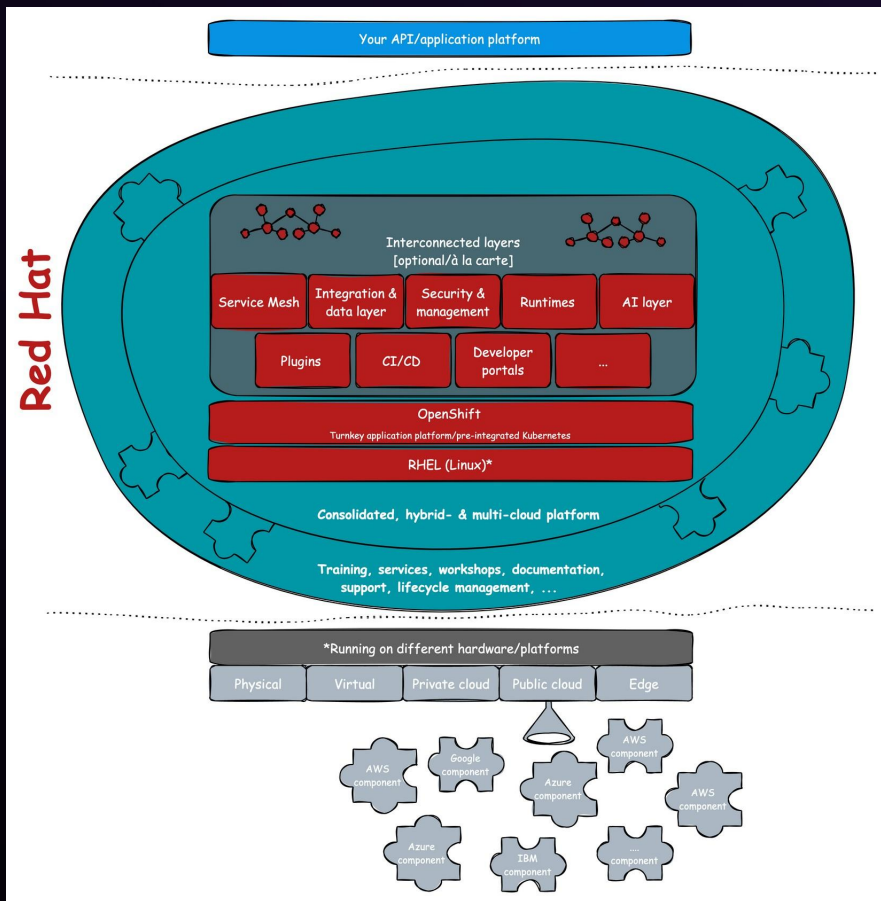
Keep your options open



maarten-vandepierre.be



Red Hat



Applications

App & AI platform

Hybrid infrastructure



So... sovereignty



What does it mean to you?



Sovereignty – (US) Cloud Act

EU data not protected from US access

21. July, 2025 11:35

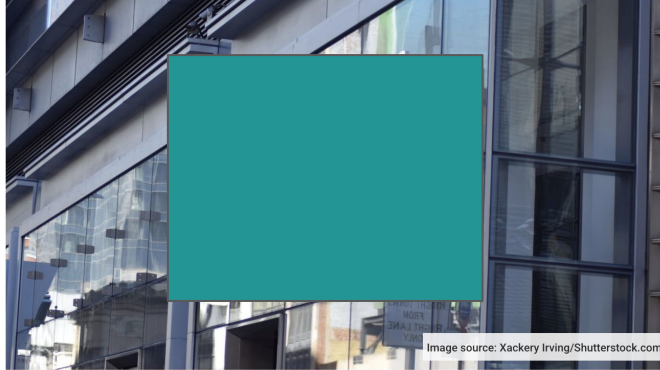


Image source: Xackery Irving/Shutterstock.com

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🇩🇪 This article is also available in German.

Explosive testimony before the French Senate: [redacted] cannot guarantee that European user data is safe from US authorities despite EU hosting.

[redacted] cannot protect European user data from access by US authorities – even if it is stored in EU data centers. This was admitted under oath by the legal director of [redacted] France, [redacted], at a [hearing before the French Senate](#) on June 10, 2025.

Cyber Security

What the CLOUD Act Really Means for EU Data Sovereignty

The CLOUD Act allows U.S. authorities to access data stored in the EU, putting it in direct conflict with GDPR. Learn how this impacts data sovereignty and what EU businesses can do to stay compliant



Wire
Jul 15, 2025



Sovereignty – EU Sovereignty framework

Twee problemen die ik voorzie

- Relatief korte levensduur van bepaalde modellen gaat ervoor zorgen dat we heel veel test werk gaan moeten doen wanneer we ergens in onze processen een LLM gebruiken dat op zogenaamd “pensioen” gaat.
 - Kan Redhat ervoor zorgen dat deze modellen ergens autonoom kunnen blijven doordraaien? Als ze op een bepaald moment in de tijd goed genoeg waren voor onze use-case, dienen we deze niet noodzakelijk te vervangen door een ander model, ookal is dit beter
- Momenteel gebruiken we bepaalde [redacted] services die, vanwege te grote vraag, ons limiteren in het aantal calls/s voor een specifiek LLM. Hierdoor is in de toekomst misschien mogelijk dat onze toepassingen niet de gewenste performantie hebben (vb. wanneer we voor 1 vraag veel parallelle calls moeten doen naar hetzelfde taalmodel, in combinatie van meerdere gebruikers die dit op dezelfde moment wensen te doen).



Sovereignty – EU Sovereignty framework

#	Sovereignty Objectives	Weight in Scoring
SOV-1	Strategic Sovereignty	15%
SOV-2	Legal & Jurisdictional Sovereignty	10%
SOV-3	Data & AI Sovereignty	10%
SOV-4	Operational Sovereignty	15%
SOV-5	Supply Chain Sovereignty	20%
SOV-6	Technology Sovereignty	15%
SOV-7	Security & Compliance Sovereignty	10%
SOV-8	Environmental Sustainability	5%
Total		100%



Sovereignty means having **full control** over your technology, data, and operations under your own legal and strategic framework. It ensures you can **operate independently**, avoid unwanted external influence, and remain resilient against legal, technical, or geopolitical dependencies.

Examples:

- You decide what you want to drink: no need to stick with beer; wine or water are valid choices too.
- You're not obliged to follow everyone to the bar. Staying on the couch is just as valid if that's what you prefer.
- You choose which pub you enter, and you're free to leave if the prices, atmosphere, or rules don't suit you.
- You can fall in love with a technology, vendor, ..., but don't marry them!



Sovereignty assessment tool



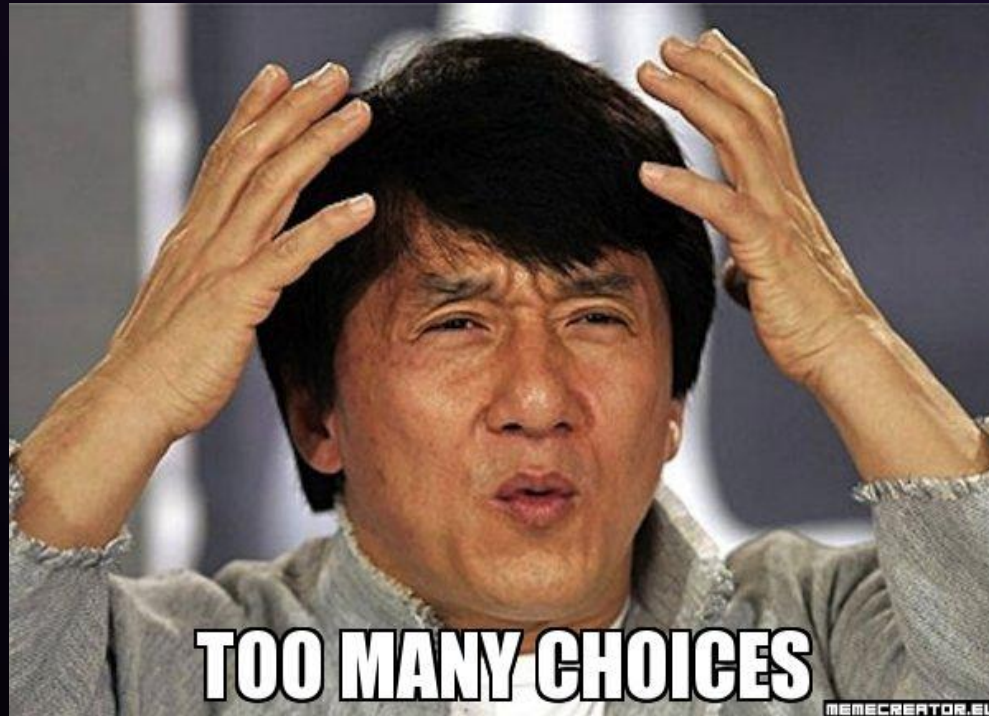
Cognitive load – Sovereignty – platform engineering

A love triangle?



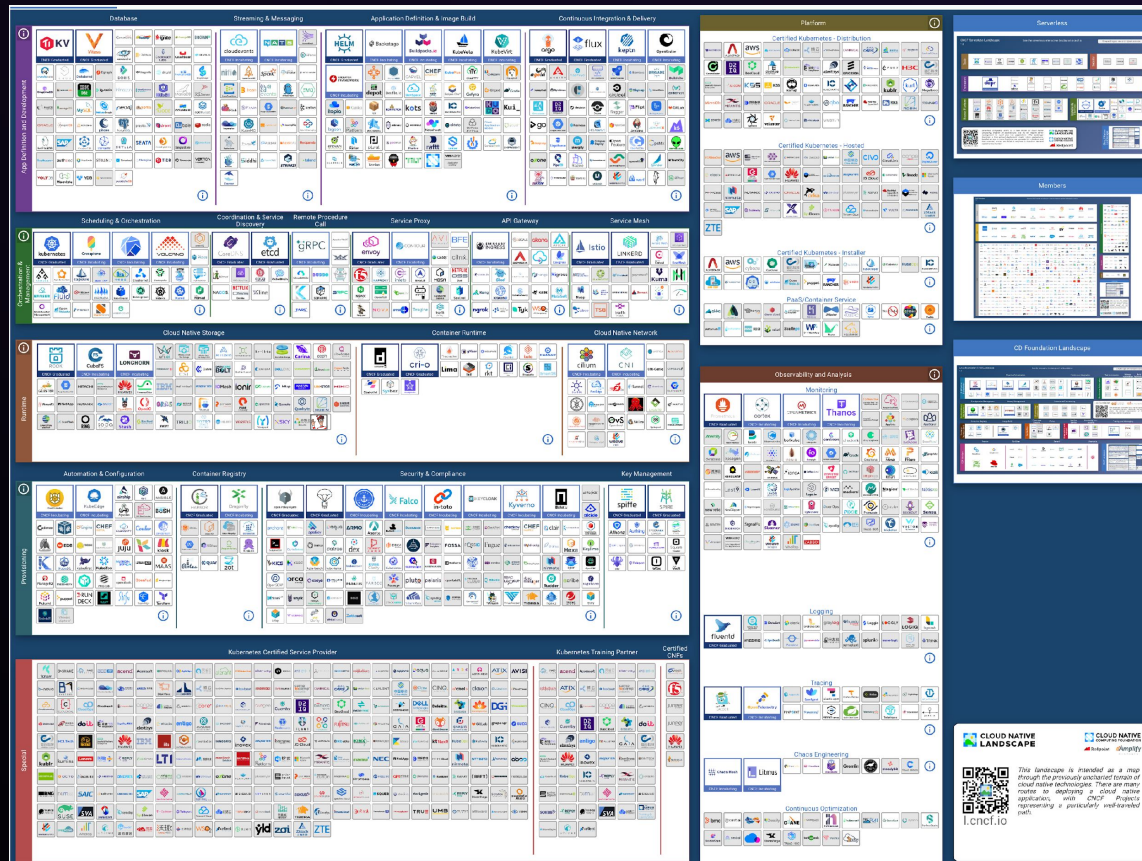
Cognitive load

Cognitive load



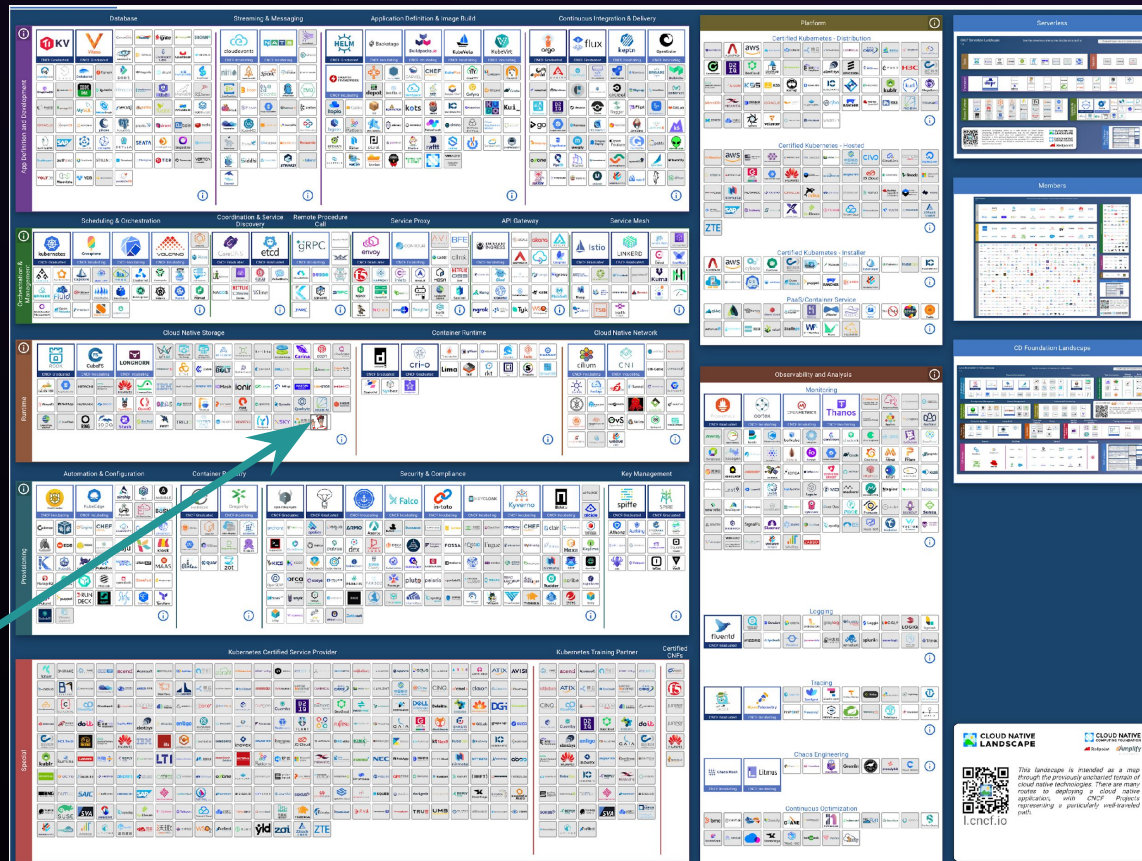
Cognitive load – Where is Wally?

(or Charly, Waldo, ...)



Cognitive load – Where is Wally?

(or Charly, Waldo, ...)



Cognitive load refers to the **amount of information** our working memory can process at any given time.

It can increase when you go beyond your **core responsibilities**.

⇒ Developers spend more time **choosing tools** than **solving problems**.

Examples:

- Choosing drinks at the bar while friends are talking, music is loud, and people are waiting.
- You ordered a cocktail, but you get the individual bottles at the table ⇒ You have to assemble it yourself.



Sovereignty

Sovereignty – EU Sovereignty framework

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SOV-1: Strategic Sovereignty

SOV-6: Technology Sovereignty

Strategic sovereignty is about maintaining leverage over time. Organizations must be able to pivot architectures, providers, and technologies without rewriting their entire digital estate.

⇒ **Open hybrid cloud**

⇒ **Open model selection**

!!!! Open Source !!!!



SOV-3: Data & AI Sovereignty

Control over data flows, model training, and inference processes.

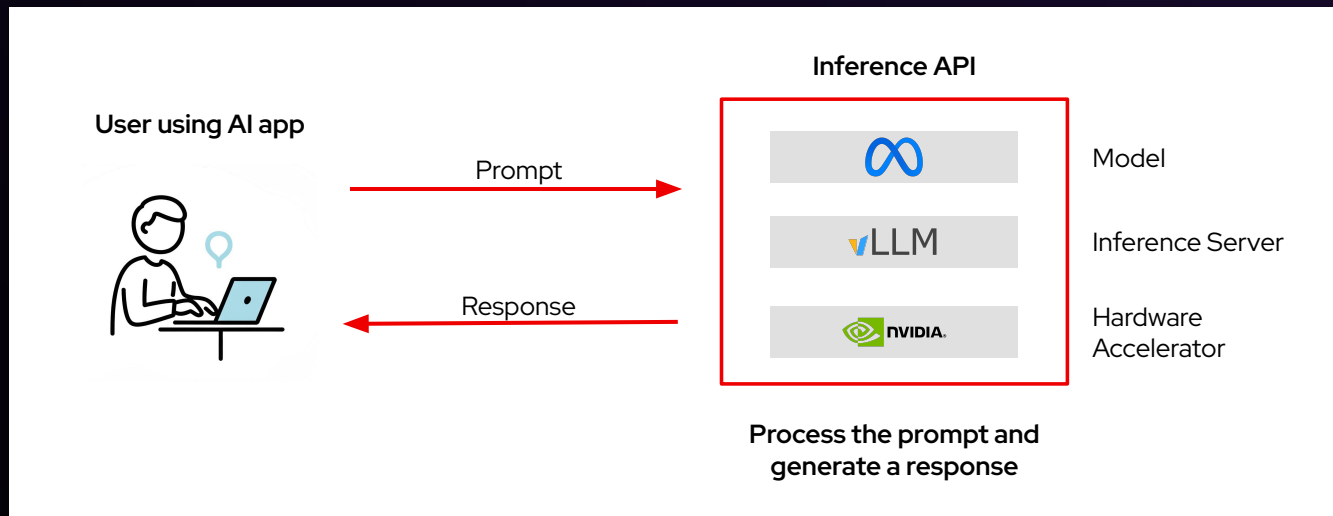
It asks: who controls the data lifecycle, and who benefits from it?

It asks: who controls the model lifecycle and the guardrails?

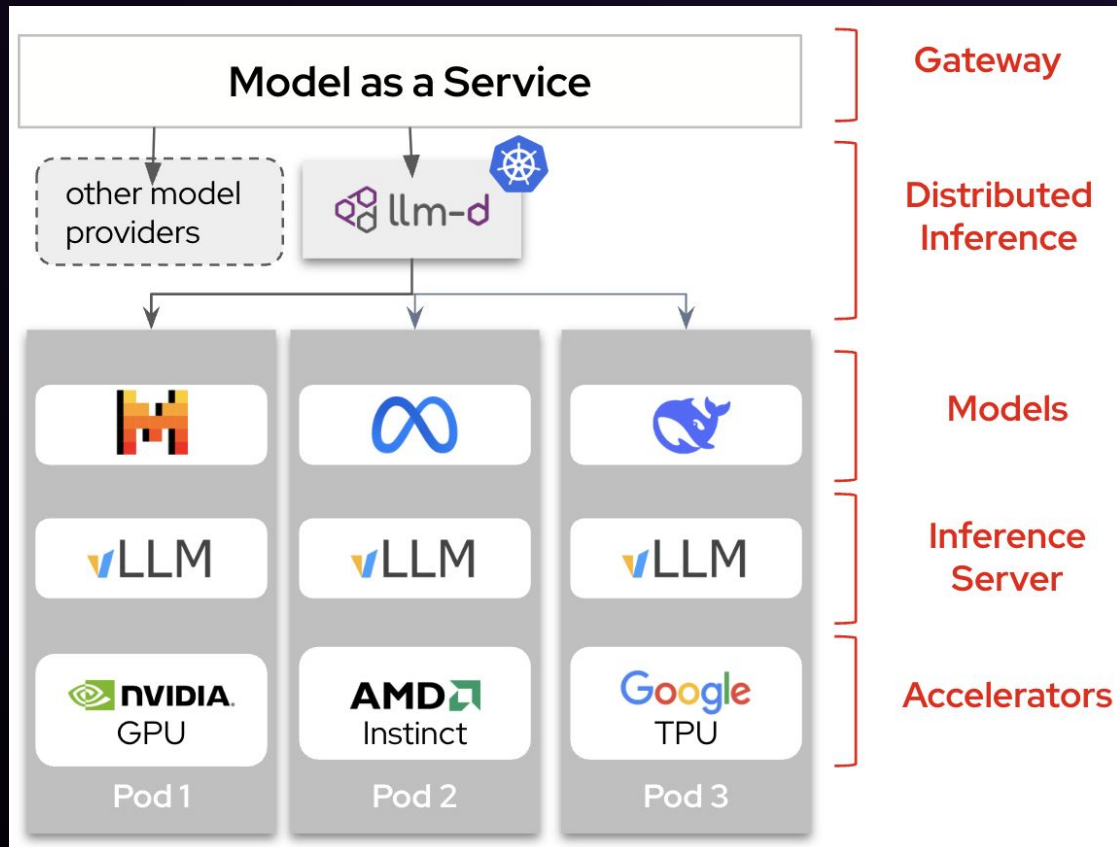


Inferencing

AI = data+model+infrastructure



Inferencing



SOV-5: Supply Chain Sovereignty

Knowing what runs in your stack and where it comes from



Keep your options open

—

**Be as independent as possible
from technology and vendors
& stay in control of your data(flows).**



Platform engineering

Make the right thing the easy thing

<https://youtu.be/DaYNwrvJGmk>

Platform engineering is the discipline of designing and building toolchains and workflows that enable **self-service** capabilities for software engineering organizations. Platform teams provide an integrated product covering the **operational necessities** of the entire lifecycle of an application (i.e., abstractions).

Examples:

- You tell the waitress what you want to drink; there's no need to go to the brewery, cool the drink, take a glass, serve the drink, and put it on the table yourself. You just order and enjoy the drink.
- The pub staff is the platform team, it abstracts away all the internals of the infrastructure, the way drinks are stored and poured,
- The cocktails are the golden paths: just order a mojito without knowing the ingredients.
- The app behind the QR code to order, can be seen as the portal on top of the platform



Cognitive load - Sovereignty - platform engineering

A love triangle?



Demo time



Keep your options open



**We differentiate on two
strategic dimensions:
control and complexity .
And we enable both through
platform engineering .**



Belgian Dev Experience Network

<https://www.meetup.com/meetup-group-judpeflp>

